7 AI Agents Your Business Could Be Using Right Now

A practical guide to automate repetitive work, connect your tools and save hours every week.

SEVEN AGENTS. THREE WORKFLOWS. ONE STARTING POINT.

GUIDE OVERVIEW

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A practical field guide to choosing, testing and managing AI agents in your business.

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01 / THE FUNDAMENTALS

Understanding AI agents

An AI agent is software that uses AI to understand a goal, choose a next step and use connected tools to carry it out. It checks the result and adjusts its actions within the limits your team sets.

A simple example

A customer asks about a delayed delivery. The agent checks the order and shipping status, then decides whether to answer or pass the case to your team.

How is it different from automation?

Traditional automation

Follows rules and steps defined in advance.

Example: Send a receipt when payment is confirmed.

AI agent

Chooses the next permitted action based on context and the results it finds.

Example: Investigate a delivery issue and decide what to do next.

Give it a clear job

Define the goal, the information it can access, the actions it may take and when it must ask for help. Use fixed rules for predictable steps and an agent where context matters.

Source: Anthropic, *Building effective agents*, December 2024.

02 / CUSTOMER-FACING AGENTS

Agents for sales and customer support

01 Sales Preparation Agent

Prepare your team for the next sales conversation. Review new enquiries, retrieve relevant CRM history and approved service information, then draft a brief and suggested follow-up.

Your business: A prospect asks about improving onboarding. The agent prepares questions for your salesperson and flags missing budget or timing.

Human review: Pricing, commitments and outbound messages.

Measure: Preparation time and corrections before use.

Real example: Microsoft reports that Fujitsu built a sales agent to support proposal creation and knowledge retrieval.

02 Customer Support Agent

Answer routine questions using approved help content and relevant account information. Pass complex cases to your team with a summary of the checks already completed.

Your business: A customer asks to change a delivery address. The agent checks the order stage, explains the options and routes exceptions to support.

Human review: Refunds and sensitive account changes.

Measure: Resolution rate, satisfaction and repeat contacts.

Real example: Lightspeed reported that Fin resolved 45–65% of support volume across its workspaces while customer satisfaction remained stable.

Reported results reflect individual implementations, not guaranteed outcomes. Sources: Microsoft, April 2025; Intercom, Lightspeed customer interview.

03 / SERVICE DELIVERY

Agents for onboarding and operations

03 Onboarding Agent

Guide a new customer or colleague through the next steps. Review submitted information, identify missing items and answer questions using approved guidance.

Your business: After a client signs, the agent checks the intake form against the agreed scope and prepares a checklist and document request.

Human review: Access permissions, scope changes and the final readiness decision.

Measure: Onboarding duration and time spent chasing missing information.

Real example: Microsoft reports that KPMG used an agent to help new hires find templates and historical references, reducing follow-up calls by 20%. This case concerns employee onboarding.

04 Operations and Document Agent

Reduce manual checking across documents and business systems. Extract information, find supporting records and flag items that do not match your agreed rules.

Your business: An invoice arrives by email. The agent finds the purchase order, compares supplier details and amounts, then flags discrepancies for your finance owner.

Human review: Payment approval, supplier changes and ambiguous matches.

Measure: Review time, missed discrepancies and false alarms.

Real example: Microsoft's November 2024 Dow case describes a pilot processing emailed PDF invoices and flagging billing issues. Employees could investigate using a second agent.

Dow's wider savings were projected outcomes, not completed results in that report. Sources: Microsoft, April 2025; Microsoft WorkLab, Dow case, November 2024.

04 / INTERNAL INTELLIGENCE

Agents for reporting and internal management

05 Reporting Agent

Prepare updates from approved data sources. Investigate changes and draft a summary with evidence. Use reporting tools to calculate the numbers.

Your business: Investigate overdue work and prepare questions for the weekly review. Label possible explanations as hypotheses.

Review and measure: A manager checks the interpretation. Track preparation time and factual corrections.

Real example: Microsoft reports that Estée Lauder's ConsumerIQ agent helps teams access consumer data and identify trends.

06 Internal Knowledge Agent

Help your team find process guidance in approved documents, with source links and access limited to their permissions.

Your business: A colleague asks which expenses need approval. The agent retrieves the policy and explains the next step.

Review and measure: Policy owners maintain the guidance. Track time to find a verified answer.

Real example: Microsoft reports that Wells Fargo introduced an agent giving staff access to guidance on 1,700 internal procedures.

07 Task Coordination Agent

Turn updates into proposed next actions. Compare meeting notes with your project board, identify blockers and prepare task updates.

Your business: A delivery is delayed. The agent checks affected tasks and drafts an update for the project owner.

Review and measure: People confirm owners, deadlines and priorities. Track administrative time and missed follow-ups.

This role is a proposed application, not a quoted customer deployment.

Source for real examples: Microsoft, April 2025.

05 / YOUR FIRST PILOT

Choose your first process
Check your readiness

Start with work your team repeats often: reading requests, searching for information, checking records, copying data or following up.

A good first process

Look for a task that happens regularly, takes meaningful time and has an outcome your team can check. If every step follows the same fixed rule, traditional automation may be enough. Consider an AI agent when context changes what should happen next.

Is your business ready?

Choose one process. Mark each item **Yes** or **Not yet**.

READINESS CHECK	YES	NOT YET
We can describe a successful result.	☐	☐
One person owns the process and the pilot.	☐	☐
The information is accurate and accessible.	☐	☐
We know what the agent may see and change.	☐	☐
Someone can review exceptions.	☐	☐
We know the current time, volume and quality.	☐	☐
We can test normal and unusual cases.	☐	☐
The team can report problems and pause the agent.	☐	☐

Before a pilot

Choose a small set of real cases. Record a baseline, review the agent's work and compare quality as well as speed. Fix missing ownership, unreliable data or unclear escalation rules before going live.

06 / FROM TRIGGER TO APPROVAL

Three workflows your business could use

These are example designs for your processes. Each combines connected tools, AI decisions and human approval.

01 Sales enquiry to follow-up

TRIGGER	AGENT	HUMAN CHECK
A website enquiry enters your CRM.	Read the request, check contact history and prepare a short brief and reply draft. Flag missing information.	A salesperson approves the reply. The workflow records the response and next task.

02 Signed client to onboarding

TRIGGER	AGENT	HUMAN CHECK
A signed agreement starts the workflow.	Compare intake details with the agreed scope. List missing items and prepare a document request.	The account owner confirms the scope and approves the request. Access or scope changes stay with the owner.

03 Weekly data to management update

TRIGGER	AGENT	HUMAN CHECK
A weekly schedule retrieves the reporting period.	Check data freshness, identify changes and draft a summary with source links.	A manager verifies findings before sharing. Inconsistent data pauses the report.

07 / PRIORITISATION WORKSHEET

Automation Opportunity Score

Score one task at a time. Choose 0, 1 or 2 for each statement, then add your points for a total out of 10.

This is a practical prioritisation tool for this guide, not a validated assessment or return-on-investment forecast.

Frequency The task happens regularly.		/ 2
Time burden It takes meaningful time each week.		/ 2
Information The required records are reliable and accessible.		/ 2
Clarity The outcome and escalation rules are clear.		/ 2
Review Your team can check and correct the result.		/ 2
TOTAL		/ 10

0–3	Clarify the process or improve the information.
4–6	Resolve gaps, then consider a limited test.
7–10	Prioritise for pilot evaluation.

Example: A support task scores 2 + 2 + 1 + 2 + 1 = 8. It may be worth testing, but the team still needs reliable information and a clear review step.

A high score signals an opportunity. It does not prove an agent is the right tool. Missing ownership, data access or escalation rules must be resolved before a live pilot.

08 / TAKE THE NEXT STEP

Your next step
Start with your process

Which process would make the biggest difference if your team spent less time managing it?

Bring one recurring task, the tools involved and an estimate of the time it takes today. Eleva Ops can help you assess where an AI agent fits, where human review belongs and how to measure a first pilot.

Book a Free Diagnosis

contact@elevaops.com

www.elevaops.com

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Reported outcomes reflect specific implementations and are not guaranteed results for your business.